

# Dry & Flaky Scalp

## Background

- Completed isotretinoin (Accutane) treatment around April 2026; now October 2026 (about 5 to 6 months post-treatment)

## Main concerns

- Scalp is much drier than before Accutane, with many flakes
- Hair texture has changed: much drier than before treatment
- Mild to moderate itch is present but not severe at baseline

## Pattern of symptoms

- Mostly fine when indoors. Hair looks good and is not very frizzy after I style it post-shower
- Symptoms flare consistently when I go outside, in any weather but worst in mild to hot heat or bright sun
- During flares: itchy tingling sensations across the whole scalp, strong itching, more flakes, and heavy frizz with my hair changing shape
- It feels like I'm reacting to something outdoors (sun, heat/sweat, pollen, or humidity are possibilities)

## What I've tried

- Head & Shoulders Clinical Anti-Dandruff Shampoo: short-term relief, no noticeable improvement long-term
- Moisturizing conditioners: short-term relief, no noticeable improvement long-term
- Trying now: Dove DermaCare Scalp Dryness & Itch Relief shampoo (pyrithione zinc), so far there is no noticeable improvement

## Not yet known / to check

- Whether this is dry scalp, seborrheic dermatitis/dandruff (yeast), sun or UV sensitivity, or allergy, or a mix

## Things I don't have

- No redness of the scalp
- No waxy or yellow flakes
- No flakes around the eyebrows, sides of the nose, or behind the ears
- No itchy eyes, sneezing, or runny nose outdoors

## Questions for the doctor

- Could this be lingering post-isotretinoin dryness or photosensitivity?
- Could seborrheic dermatitis or a yeast component be involved?
- Could an environmental allergy be contributing?
- What shampoo, treatment, or sun protection do you recommend for my scalp?
- How long might it take for my scalp and hair to return to normal?

# Chronic Throat Clearing

## Background

- Lifelong throat clearing, most noticeable over the past few years
- Mild dust allergy as a child, since outgrown
- Mild exercise-related lung fatigue (tires faster than others during sports, not life-threatening enough for inhaler use, no feeling of being unable to breathe)
- Past eczema flares, cleared with prescription cream and no recurrence
- Small harmless bumps on upper arms (likely keratosis pilaris)
- Completed isotretinoin around April 2026 (the throat clearing predates it)

## Main concerns

- Constant urge to clear throat, with a sensation of a lump or something stuck
- Clearing is dry, with nothing coming up
- Occasional cough

## Pattern of symptoms

- No clear pattern: tested food type, meal size, time of day, dust, and indoor vs outdoor, with no consistent effect

## What I've tried

- Antihistamines: no real benefit; one type made it noticeably worse (I was prescribed PANTOPROZOLE MAGN but when that ran out I got an alternative PANTAPROZOLE SOD and this alternative made things noticeably worse. The day I stopped it I got better)
- Nasal spray: not tried long enough to judge, no noticeable relief
- Daily food log: no trigger found

## What I don't have

- No heartburn or sour taste
- No postnasal drip or congestion
- No hoarseness, voice fatigue, or trouble swallowing
- No smoking, vaping, or irritant exposure
- No weight loss, blood, or throat pain

## Not yet known / to check

- Silent reflux (laryngopharyngeal reflux), which can occur without heartburn
- Habit-based or tic-like clearing that persists once established
- Whether mild asthma or cough-variant asthma is involved
- Whether an allergic or nasal component exists despite no obvious congestion
- Whether a laryngeal exam is warranted to rule out a structural cause

## Questions for the doctor

- Could this be silent reflux even without heartburn, and is a trial of treatment reasonable?
- Could it be a habitual clearing pattern, and how is that managed?
- Could my mild exercise-related lung fatigue and occasional cough point to mild or cough-variant asthma? Should I get breathing tests?
- Should I try the nasal spray for longer, and which type?
- Could my eczema and allergy history be connected?